Supplementary File 2 – Example search strategy (Medline)

1 (break* adj3 news).tw.
2 ((difficult or bad or traumatic) adj3 news).tw.
3 ((communicat* or tell* or convey* or disclos* or giv*) adj2 (diagnos* or prognos*)).tw.
4 ((inform or news) adj2 patient*).tw.
5 (information provision or information exchange* or receiving the news).tw.
6 (recovery adj2 (expect* or conversation*)).tw.
7 (truth-telling or truth disclosure).tw.
8 Truth Disclosure/
9 or/1-8 [breaking bad news]
10 (brain injur* or head injur* or spinal cord injur* or spinal injur* or multiple sclerosis or demyelinating disease* or Parkinson* or dementia or Alzheimer* or vascular cognitive impair* or lewy bod* or huntington* or korsako* or motor neuron* disease or Gehrig syndrome or amyotrophic lateral sclerosis or brain tumo?r or stroke* or hemiplegia).tw.
11 (neurological adj2 (impair* or disease* or disorder* or condition*)).tw.
12 Brain Injuries/
13 Spinal Injuries/
14 Multiple Sclerosis/
15 Parkinson Disease/
16 Dementia/ or Dementia, Multi-Infarct/ or Dementia, Vascular/ or Frontotemporal Dementia/
17 Alzheimer Disease/
18 Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis/
19 Brain Neoplasms/
20 Stroke/
21 Hemiplegia/
22 or/10-21 [neurological conditions]
23 9 and 22
24 limit 23 to english language
25 exp animals/ not humans.sh.
26 24 not 25 [human only filter]
27 (exp Child/ or Adolescent/ or exp Infant/) not exp Adult/
28 26 not 27 [adult only filter]
29 remove duplicates from 28